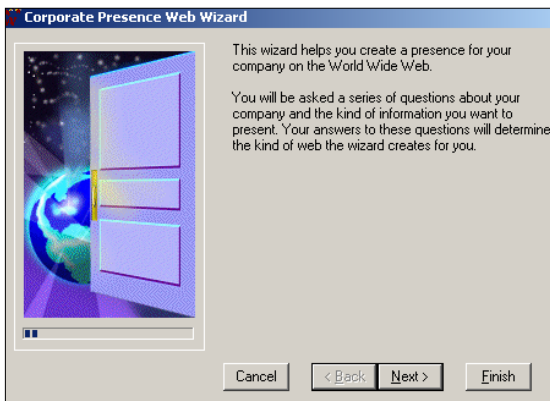


to build a site from the templates that Frontpage offers, or choose “Page Templates...” to build a single page from the templates. If you are familiar with HTML or Frontpage, you can also choose the “Blank Page” option to build a page or site from scratch.

Your Organisation Online

Let's say you want to create your company's presence online. Click **File > New > Page or Web...**, and



Choose Corporate Presentation to build your company's Web site easily with the help of a wizard

choose the “Web Site Templates...” option. A box pops up, informing you of the currently available templates.

Choose “Corporate Presence Wizard”, which is the easiest way to build a company Web site. The Frontpage wizard will now ask you a series of questions.

You can choose what pages your Web site will contain—What's New, Products/Services, Table of Contents, etc. Then you get to choose topics that will appear on your home page, such as an Introduction, a Mission Statement, your Company Profile, etc.

Next, you choose whether you want pages to display Press Releases, Articles and Reviews, etc. Now when you click “Next,” you get to choose what is displayed on the top of each page, such as your company logo, the page title, a link bar, etc.

Next, you can set Frontpage to use its default “Under Construction” icon for unfinished pages, so that people don't hit dead links in case you forgot to create a page.

Now all that's left is to fill in your company details, choose a colour scheme and button images (called a “Web Theme” in Frontpage), and then click “Finish.”

A new folder will be created in “My Documents\My Webs” called “My Web”. This folder will contain the Web site you are currently designing. Depending on what pages you chose to include in your site when using the Wizard, you will find a few .html or .htm files in this folder. You need to edit these according to your needs.

The beauty of Frontpage is its sheer simplicity, and this is evident when you open an unedited page. You are instructed through everything from adding your Web site's logo, to adding contact information.

Frontpage advises, “Tell readers how to get in touch with you. Remember that people can connect to your web from anywhere in the world, so provide international versions of telephone and fax numbers. It's also customary to provide e-mail addresses for key contact points, such as sales and customer support.”

Every detail is explained similarly, and all you need to do is double-click on text or images to edit them. Just go through the pages one by one, adding images, text and various details that Frontpage puts dummy text or images for.

Keep It Simple

People often get carried away and try and pack too much into their Web sites. Your goal should be to inform people about your company, what you do, and how they can contact you. Anything more will be wasted, and will clutter your page.

As a rule of thumb, remember that people have short atten-

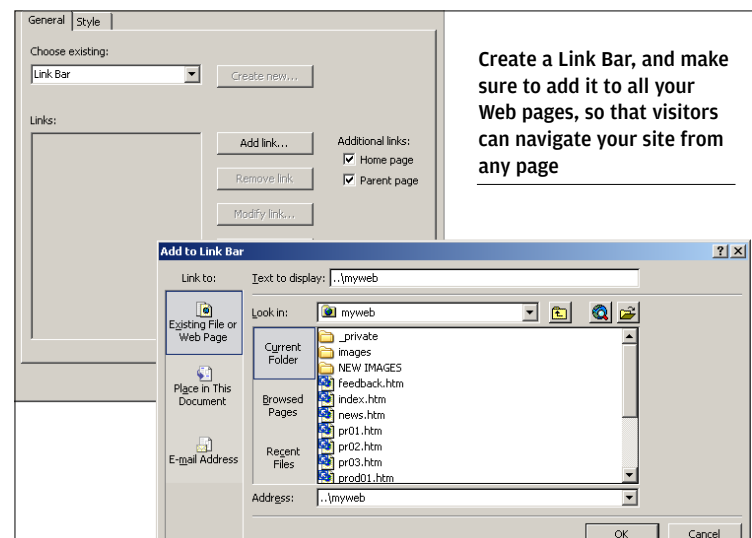
tion spans these days, and this becomes even shorter when they are surfing. Long paragraphs of text that describe your products and the various stages of ideation your company went through, etc., are a sure-fire way of losing a visitor's interest.

Get to the point. Make sure everything you're trying to highlight is visible straight up—if you're trying to sell a product, make sure its picture and a brief explanation show right in the centre of the window.

Keep the text simple, and use numbers in text—writing four thousand three hundred and seventy five instead of 4,375 is a big thumbs-down. Also, break the paragraphs up with sub-headlines, and use bulleted lists and a single column format to improve readability.

Make sure that all pages you create have the same link bar, so as to prevent visitors from getting lost. In Frontpage, you can choose to create a link bar by going to **Insert > Navigation**. A box will pop up. Choose “Link Bars” and click “Next.” Now choose the page theme, click “Next” and choose the orientation of the link bar—horizontal or vertical. Click “Finish,” and then add the pages you want to on the link bar. Remember, not every page on your Web site needs to be mentioned here—just the most important pages. You can always link to lower-level pages from within other pages.

Though you can insert backgrounds and background sounds, this will only increase the time it takes to load the pages. If you absolutely must have a textured



Create a Link Bar, and make sure to add it to all your Web pages, so that visitors can navigate your site from any page